Getting started with the GMH Uncertainty Translator

A free AI assistant that turns your raw cattle data (your own Excel/CSV files, whatever shape they're in) into the strict template the Cattle Uncertainty App needs. **About 10 minutes, no installation, no payment.**

Before you start

You'll need:

1. Your raw inventory data file(s) — Excel, CSV, or even a PDF/screenshot of a table.
2. The filled **Pre-flight Questionnaire** (`questionnaire.md` — download from the app's Resources tab).
3. About 10 minutes.

Step-by-step

1. Open claude.ai and sign in (free)

- Go to **https://claude.ai**
- Click **Sign up** if you don't have an account. The free tier is enough for this task. You can sign in with Google, email, or Apple — no payment details needed.

2. Open the Translator Project

- Click this shared link: **GMH Uncertainty Translator**
- *(If the link doesn't work, see the "Backup option" at the bottom of this page.)*

You'll land in a chat window pre-loaded with the parameter catalogue, template schema, and mapping examples for the app. Claude knows everything it needs to translate your data.

3. Paste your filled questionnaire as your first message

- Open `questionnaire.md` (or your filled `.docx` version), select all, copy.
- Paste it as the first message into the Translator chat.
- Send.

Claude will briefly summarise back what it understood, and ask which file(s) you'd like to upload.

4. Upload your raw data file(s)

- Click the **paperclip icon** in the chat input box.
- Select your file(s) — `.xlsx`, `.csv`, `.pdf`, or images of tables all work.
- Send.

Claude will inspect the file, propose a column-mapping table, and **ask you to confirm anything ambiguous**.

5. Answer Claude's clarification questions

You'll typically see 2–5 questions like:

- "Your column `weight` — is this body weight (current) or mature weight (adult target)?"
- "Your milk yield column is in litres — should I convert to kg using ×1.03, or treat 1 L = 1 kg?"

Answer in plain language. Claude will adjust and re-confirm.

6. Receive the filled template

When Claude is satisfied, it will produce **`filled_template_for_app.xlsx`** as a downloadable file (click the download icon next to it in the chat).

> If Claude tells you the analysis tool is unavailable and instead gives you three CSV blocks (Inventory_Metadata, Parameters, Manure_Management), follow the "Backup option" at the bottom of this page.

7. Open the Cattle Uncertainty App → Data Input tab → upload the file

- In the app's **Data Input** tab, click **Upload your filled template (.xlsx)**.
- Select `filled_template_for_app.xlsx`.
- The app will validate the file and load it. Any issues will show in the **QA/QC** tab — green = OK, amber = review, red = fix.

You're now ready to run the uncertainty simulation.

Tips for a smooth session

- **Be specific.** "Population in column B is total dairy cattle in 2022" beats "B is animals".
- **Tell Claude when something is wrong.** If a unit conversion looks off, just say "wait — that should be 275 kg, not 599 kg" and Claude will fix it.
- **Ask Claude to explain.** "Why did you set Ym = 6.5?" is a fine question. It'll cite the IPCC table.
- **Don't worry about advanced parameters.** The 16 IPCC coefficients (Cfi, Ca, Ym, EF3, …) ship with sensible defaults. You only need to provide them if you have country-specific measurements.

Privacy

Claude.ai uses your messages and uploads in line with Anthropic's privacy policy. For national GHG inventory data this is generally fine because the data is intended for public reporting under the UNFCCC. If your ministry has a policy against uploading internal data to third-party AI services, **do not use this tool** — fill the template manually from the app's Resources tab instead.

Backup option — if the Project link doesn't work, or Claude can't generate the .xlsx

You can still get most of the value from any AI chat:

1. Open any free AI chat: claude.ai, ChatGPT, Gemini.
2. Paste the contents of `param_catalogue.md` and `template_schema.md` (download both from the app's Resources tab) as your first message, followed by: *"You are the GMH Uncertainty Translator. Use the schema above to help me convert my raw data into per-sheet CSV blocks. Ask me the standard six onboarding questions first."*
3. Paste your filled questionnaire and proceed as in Steps 4–5 above.
4. When the AI produces three CSV blocks (one per sheet), open the **blank template** (download it from the app's Data Input tab → "Download blank template"), paste each block into the matching sheet starting at row 4, save, and upload.

This is slower but works on any AI without the persistent Project.

When the AI gets it wrong

The Translator is a helper, not an oracle. Always:

- **Spot-check** the key numbers (population, body weight, milk yield) by comparing with your original file.
- **Watch the QA/QC tab** for amber/red flags after upload — those highlight values outside IPCC ranges.
- **Tell us** when something is off. Use the in-app Feedback tab to report mistranslations so we can improve the prompt.

Made by the CGIAR Alliance, Climate Action–Net Zero Initiative, Project D614 — GMH Emissions Uncertainty. Questions: M.Lolita@cgiar.org.